

Mobile Madness

You have to try these games out on your smartphone!

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Astra

This month's wonderfully weird Play Store game is Astra, which can be described as a gladiator's adventures in space.

The mission in Astra is to guide a small Roman man on his adventures across solar systems as he launches himself into orbit head-



Lunar Mission

Lunar Mission is about one of the greatest endeavours of the human race: the mission to the moon. This game challenges you to land a moon lander without any damage to its parts. The game has a bare pixelated look and you can feel the darkness of space closing in on you. It takes a long time getting used to the controls and to judge the amount and direction of thrust you need to apply for the moon lander to get back to the ground undamaged. Each ship has four modules and the number of stars you get in each module depends on how many modules remain unharmed.

There are three levels of difficulty, - fast and auto stabilised scout, the slow and heavy cargo ship and the limited fuel original lander, each with 24 levels. The soundtrack is minimalist, just like the game and you only hear the concerned mission control when your ship is almost destroyed. The game tends to get quite monotonous due to the lack of variety. Though, if you love a challenge, this one perfect for you.

Hyperburner

Hyperburner is a space-based endless runner that you have been waiting for. The game requires you to manoeuvre a spaceship in various levels strewn across the galaxy, like a debris-filled space field, an industrial mega cluster and more. The code, art and music have all been created by just one person, the hugely talented Patrick Cook and superb UI with its slick design and space age graphics is by Eva Godeny. There are five levels of increasing difficulty on each of the six stages, with personal high scores to be set on each.

This game can be played in both the landscape and portrait orienta-



first (Helmet first, rather). The objective? One would like to imagine that this new age Hercules is out to repent for mistakes of the past. One touch control means you only need to tap for jumps and hold to escape gravity and float to another planet. The modes are normal and hard, and each of the 15 levels has three goals to complete.

The design is inspired by art found on Greco-Roman pottery, which makes it especially striking. The enemies are humanoid space wolves, moths and boars, which can be killed by jumping on them, a la Mario. Visuals are dark and subdued which, with the Roman war like outer space soundtrack, lends the game an atmospheric feel. There are no ads whatsoever in the game and it is absolutely free.